Basic bidding Notrump raises Major suit raises

This set of practice deals focuses on basic bidding situations. There are no conventions used except for one deal which uses Blackwood. Even that is optional.

The deals are designed with the beginning player in mind, or perhaps those who feel the need to refresh themselves on the fundamentals of bidding.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in finding a fit and deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam.

Keep in mind:
- a combined 8-card trump fit is desired to play in a suit
- it takes 26 points to make game in Notrump or a Major suit
- it takes 33 points to make small slam

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦9

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠2

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♣5

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♥K

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A 8 3 2
♥ K 10 9
♦ A J 7
♣ K Q 6

♠ Q 5
♥ 6 5 3 2
♦ 10 4 3
♣ A 7 4 3

♠ K J 7 6
♥ A 8 7
♦ 9 8 6
♣ 10 8 2

♠ 10 9 4
♥ Q J 4
♦ K Q 5 2
♣ J 9 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North
Lead: ♦9

This is a classic Notrump bidding sequence.

NORTH opens 1NT with 17 points and balanced distribution. SOUTH, with 9 points is not strong enough to bid game, but invites with 2NT. NORTH has a maximum, so she accepts the invitation.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 9 7 5 3 ♥ 10 9 8 ♦ K Q 9 3 ♣ J 5	
♠ K J 8 4 ♥ A K 7 2 ♦ 6 5 ♣ K 9 3		♠ A Q 10 6 ♥ 5 4 ♦ A 8 7 4 ♣ A 8 2
	♠ 2 ♥ Q J 6 3 ♦ J 10 2 ♣ Q 10 7 6 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♦	Pass
1♥	Pass	1♠	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			

4♠ by East
Lead: ♠2

With two 4-card Majors WEST should respond "up-the-line", bidding ♥s first.

Then, after EAST bids 1♠, WEST has enough points to jump all the way to 4♠.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ A 9 6 3 ♥ Q 6 4 ♦ A 9 6 2 ♣ J 7	
♠ 2 ♥ J 10 5 2 ♦ J 8 7 3 ♣ 9 8 5 3	N W E S	♠ J 7 5 ♥ K 9 8 3 ♦ 10 4 ♣ A K 4 2
	♠ K Q 10 8 4 ♥ A 7 ♦ K Q 5 ♣ Q 10 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by South
Lead: ♣5

SOUTH has 17 points and might open 1NT. But with the 5-card Major suit she prefers to open 1♠.

NORTH has excellent ♠ support but with 11 points is not quite strong enough to insist on reaching game. Instead he makes an invitational jump to 3♠, which SOUTH is strong enough to raise to game.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

♠ 10 9 3
♥ K Q 7 5 2
♦ 5 3
♣ Q 6 4

♠ A K 6
♥ A J 9
♦ A J 2
♣ A 8 5 2

♠ 8 7
♥ 10 6 4
♦ K Q 10 9 6
♣ 10 7 3

♠ Q J 5 4 2
♥ 8 3
♦ 8 7 4
♣ K J 9

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
2NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			

3NT by West
Lead: ♥K

WEST has a powerful hand, but 21 points is not strong enough to start with a forcing 2♣ bid. Since he has balanced distribution he opens 2NT (20-21 points).

EAST adds her 6 points to WEST's minimum and concludes they should be in game. She expects her good ♦ suit to be useful to EAST in Notrump so she bids 3NT.